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elling up on Steam. And maybe it's time we delve into the tweaks and added tricks that add to the convenience of being a part of the Steam community.

Steam apprenticeship

Here are the basics from the 'The Zen of Steaming'. Aside from what third party sources have to offer, Steam has some built-in features to make your gaming lives convenient. Here are a few:

Backup your games: Despite the convenience of downloadable games, it's always more comforting to have a DVD or some kind of physical avatar of your games in case of a system breakdown. Unlike certain other game distributors, backing up the game files of Steam is an easy process. In your client, go to Steam>Backup and Restore Games>Backup currently installed programs, and let the Steam client do its thing. Follow the same steps to restore said backups when needed. Simple, convenient,

easy as pie. Remember, however, in case of a game update, you may need to create a new backup after deleting the old one, unless you intend to re-download from when you took your last backup.

To bypass this step entirely, there is the easier method of entering C:/Program Files (x86)/Steam/SteamApps/Common (replace the path with wherever you've installed Steam) and copying the game files directly. Any issues with missing files or file corruption during the transfer will be fixed by Steam when you replace these files into the same path later.

Verify the integrity of the game cache: Sometimes your games may crash regularly, or at a particular point in the game, or maybe even refuse to start up. Don't freak out. It's possible that your files have gotten corrupt, or even missing because you unintentionally deleted it. Simply right-click on the game in your steam library, select 'Properties' and enter the 'Local Files' tab. The 'Verify the integrity of the

game cache' button will fix most of these problems for you. Steam will recheck the files on your PC, and delete/re-download the problematic files.

Outfox your Steam

If you're a Firefox fanboy and are a regular on Steam, look out for the Enhanced Steam add-on. The personalization options help add a little more to

add-on is that it's meant specifically for Firefox, so Chrome and Safari users are out of luck.

Moving the files around

Yes, Steam has a backup option, but in situations when you want to change the location of all your Steam install files from one partition to the other, you need something like Steam Mover. Steam mover is a third



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your Steam browser experience. You can change the tab colours of the website UI to change colours as per what you've already purchased, what's on your wishlist, and so on. Enhanced Steam also gives you the option to remove that annoying 'Install Steam' button that crops up at the top of your webpage, along with options to remove some of the other irritating aspects of the Steam page.

Getting it is a minute's job. Simply go to <http://dgit.in/enSteam> and click on 'Download now'. The only downside to this

party software. This software makes it much easier for you to transfer your entire Steam Library exactly the way it is from one location to the other. It creates junction points at the primary location to your selected secondary location. The biggest advantage of Steam Mover is that you can store copies of all your steam games on multiple drives without it hindering your ability to game on. Steam Mover makes it unnecessary to uninstalling and re-installing to make a sufficient amount of space on your pri-

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